



Agile production

Speed and agility are the key competitive advantages of agile production: the focus is on rapid response to the customer, enabling the business to take advantage of short windows of opportunity.

How it works

The goal of agile production is to stay ahead of the competition. Often incorporating concepts of lean production (*see pp.288–289*), agile has an extra dimension: meeting customer demand rapidly and effectively. It relies on flexible and collaborative workers, who can deliver swiftly and effectively. The company has to be able to change or increase production quickly. Design of products might incorporate modular concepts, allowing for customization, and strong relationships with suppliers are essential.

